RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

19 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 6:04 PM, Monday 19 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 123 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 26 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 11,310 minutes at 6:00 PM (SV918 landed 4:27 PM); Dammam moving, no open halt

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 11,310 minutes at 6:00 PM; one special landing SV918 from Liege at 4:27 PM, no other movements**.
- 123 Riyadh flights cancelled today so far (21% of all scheduled); NOTAMs still require prior GACA permission and bar Riyadh as an alternate.
- Civil Defense early-warning alerts for Riyadh and Al-Kharj at ~4:58–4:59 PM, all-clear by 5:08 PM; Najran alerted and cleared ~3:16–3:19 PM.
- Dammam airport moving with no halt since 12 PM: 5 takeoffs and 8 landings since 3 PM, latest XY812 from Dubai at 5:59 PM.
- No MoD or Coalition intercept statement yet for the 5 PM Riyadh/Al-Kharj window; filming of interceptions remains legally restricted.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (11315 min).

123	0/0	5
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

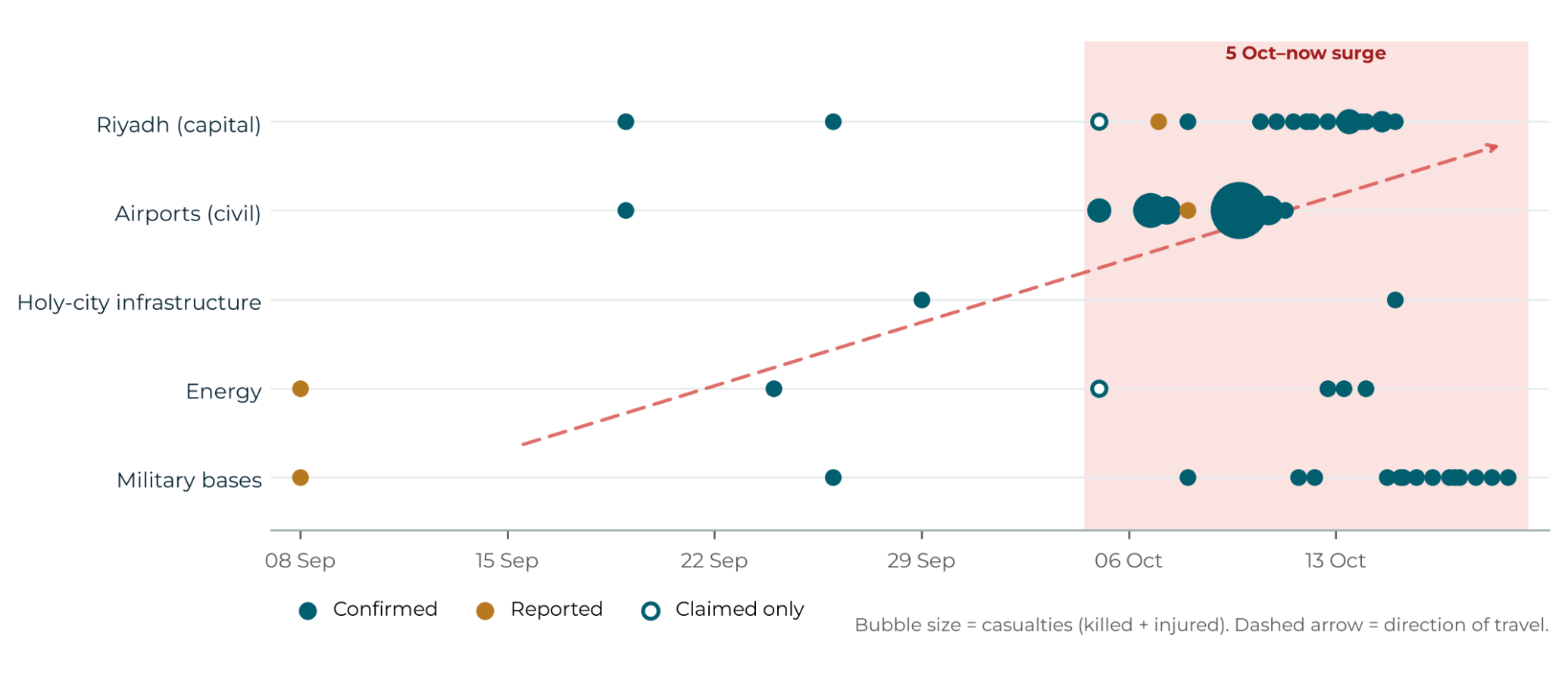
0 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

26	0/2	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (11,131 min at 3:00 PM); DPA reports a NOTAM reopening, but no GACA statement and no flights on the board
- No new attack, interception or Civil Defense alert in Saudi Arabia since 12:00 PM
- SPA: France's foreign minister condemns the Houthi attacks during talks with Prince Faisal bin Farhan (2:16 PM)
- Dammam since 12 PM: 8 takeoffs (latest flynas XY811 to Dubai 2:42 PM) and 7 landings (latest flynas XY406 from Jeddah 2:33 PM), no halt
- Lufthansa extends its Riyadh suspension to 18 Nov; Qatar Airways, Etihad and flydubai cancel Riyadh and Dammam through 24 Oct

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 19 OCT



Bubble size = casualties (killed + injured). Dashed arrow = direction of travel.

50 sourced events since 8 September (44 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region (18 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

2

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 3:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED ALERT **3:16 PM AST · Najran**
Civil Defense early-warning alert issued for Najran Province to warn of a potential danger. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALL-CLEAR **3:19 PM AST · Najran**
Civil Defense all-clear for Najran Province; danger passed. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALERT **4:58 PM AST · Riyadh**
Civil Defense early-warning alert issued for Riyadh City to warn of a potential danger. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALERT **4:59 PM AST · Al-Kharj**
Civil Defense early-warning alert issued for Al-Kharj Governorate to warn of a potential danger. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALL-CLEAR **5:07 PM AST · Riyadh**
Civil Defense all-clear for Riyadh City; danger passed. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALL-CLEAR **5:08 PM AST · Al-Kharj**
Civil Defense all-clear for Al-Kharj Governorate; danger passed. Saudi Civil Defense

Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, alerts 5, all-clears 5.

3

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh still halted despite reopening reports; France condemns Houthi attacks; Dammam moving

Checked at 6:04 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Riyadh City, then all-clear (danger passed)**
Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **4:58 PM** · published 4:58–5:07 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 6:04 PM
National Early Warning Platform alert for Riyadh City at 4:58 PM AST; all-clear at 5:07 PM. Civil Defense also warned against filming or sharing information on missile/drone interceptions and impact sites.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Al-Kharj Governorate, then all-clear (danger passed)**
Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **4:59 PM** · published 4:59–5:08 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 6:04 PM
National Early Warning Platform alert for Al-Kharj Governorate at 4:59 PM AST; all-clear at 5:08 PM. No MoD/Coalition intercept statement published for this window as of check.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Civil Defense early warning then all-clear for Riyadh and Al-Kharj**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:01 PM** · published 5:01–5:08 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 6:04 PM
Breaking: Civil Defense issued early warning for Riyadh and Al-Kharj, then announced danger had passed for both.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Najran Province, then all-clear (danger passed)**
Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **3:16 PM** · published 3:16–3:19 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 6:04 PM
National Early Warning Platform alert for Najran Province at 3:16 PM AST; all-clear at 3:19 PM.

CONFIRMED **Saudi MOFA: Foreign Minister receives French Foreign Minister in Riyadh**
Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **5:12 PM** · published 5:12 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 6:04 PM
Foreign Minister HH Prince Faisal bin Farhan receives French Foreign Minister. Earlier SPA said France condemned Houthi attacks on the Kingdom.

CONFIRMED **Anadolu Agency: Saudi Civil Defense says danger has passed in Riyadh and Al-Kharj after security alerts**
Anadolu Agency · **5:30 PM** · published Mon 19 Oct; checked 6:04 PM
Saudi authorities said danger has passed in Riyadh and Al-Kharj after early warning alerts; residents urged to follow instructions and avoid gathering and filming.

CONFIRMED **Houthi ballistic missiles hit a security training centre in Shabwa, Yemen**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) / AP · 1:39 PM · **1:39 PM** · published 1:39 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (Yemeni armed forces spokesman via Al Ekhbariya); AP cites two Yemeni officials; checked 2:52 PM AST
The Yemeni armed forces spokesman said the Houthis fired 3 ballistic missiles at a training centre for security and police personnel in Shabwa province. AP, citing two Yemeni military officials, says at least 20 government soldiers were killed at the al-Alam camp. This strike was inside Yemen, not on Saudi territory.

CONFIRMED DMM **SPA: Eastern Province Emir receives the CEO of Dammam Airports**
SPA (@SPAregions) · 1:40 PM · **1:40 PM** · published 1:40 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 2:52 PM AST
The Eastern Province Emir and his deputy each received the chief executive of Dammam Airports and were briefed on the company's work. SPA gave no operational update on King Fahd International Airport.

UNVERIFIED **DPA: a NOTAM issued early Monday reopens Riyadh airport, but the board still shows no flights**
DPA (via Yahoo News) · 1:03 PM · **1:03 PM** · published 6:03 AM EDT (1:03 PM AST) Mon 19 Oct; The National also reports a reopening; checked 2:52 PM AST
DPA reports a NOTAM issued early Monday reopened King Khalid International Airport for takeoffs and landings, and cites Flightradar24 saying more than 80% of Monday's flights were cancelled. GACA has issued no reopening statement, and the live board shows no takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM on 11 Oct. DPA says Lufthansa Group extended its Riyadh suspension to 18 Nov and British Airways and KLM won't fly before the end of October.

CORROBORATED **The National: many airlines keep Saudi suspensions in place, some into November and 2027**
The National · Mon 19 Oct · **Mon 19 Oct** · published Mon 19 Oct (time not shown); matches DPA; checked 2:52 PM AST
Etihad, flydubai and Qatar Airways have cancelled Riyadh and Dammam flights up to and including 24 Oct, Oman Air has suspended Riyadh until 22 Oct, and SalamAir has cancelled Riyadh and Dammam until 31 Oct. British Airways plans a limited daily Riyadh service from 3 Nov, and Cathay Pacific has extended its Riyadh suspension to 31 Jan 2027.

UNVERIFIED **AP: Saudi Arabia opens a probe into its air-defence failure at Riyadh airport on 10 Oct**
AP · Mon 19 Oct · **Mon 19 Oct** · published Mon 19 Oct (time not shown); two unnamed regional officials; checked 2:52 PM AST
AP reports, citing two regional officials, that Saudi Arabia is investigating how its air defences failed to intercept the missile and drone barrage that included the airport attack that killed at least 13 people and wounded more than 300. There is no official Saudi statement on the probe.

UNVERIFIED **Aviation report: NOTAM opens Riyadh only to flights with prior GACA permission**
Inside Aviation News · 4:21 PM · **4:21 PM** · published 1321Z (4:21 PM AST) Sun 18 Oct; NOTAM text not checked directly; checked 11:58 AM
Inside Aviation News says NOTAM A3650/26, effective 9:45 PM AST Saturday 17 Oct, requires prior GACA permission for every arrival and departure at Riyadh, and NOTAM A3651/26 bars the airport as a diversion alternate. It says Riyadh Air cancelled its long-haul, Dubai and Cairo round trips again for 19 Oct plus five Riyadh-Jeddah round trips. Some outlets describe this as a reopening, but GACA has issued no reopening statement and the Flightradar24 board still shows no takeoff or landing.

CONFIRMED **Saudi MOFA: Riyadh | Deputy Minister for Political Affairs Ambassador Dr. Saud Al-Sati held a meeting with ambassadors of Asian, North American, Latin American, a**
Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **12:56 PM** · published 12:56 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 2:45 PM
#Riyadh | Deputy Minister for Political Affairs Ambassador Dr. Saud Al-Sati held a meeting with ambassadors of Asian, North American, Latin American, and Oceanian countries accredited to the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to check flight status with their airline**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **10:13 AM** · published 10:13 AM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account, reply in Arabic, translated); checked 11:58 AM
Replying to a passenger on X, the airport's official account asked travellers to contact their airline to confirm the status of their flight and get updates. It gave no reopening date.

CONFIRMED **Saudi MOFA: Vice Foreign Minister Waleed Elkhereiji meets Arab ambassadors in Riyadh**
Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **10:25 AM** · published 10:25 AM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 11:58 AM
The Vice Minister of Foreign Affairs held a meeting in Riyadh with Arab ambassadors accredited to the Kingdom. No details of the agenda were given.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Pakistan and Egypt foreign ministers condemn Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia and seek a four-way meeting**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **4:53 AM** · published 4:53 AM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 11:58 AM
SPA says the foreign ministers of Pakistan and Egypt condemned the Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and called for a quadrilateral meeting.

4

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (11315 min).

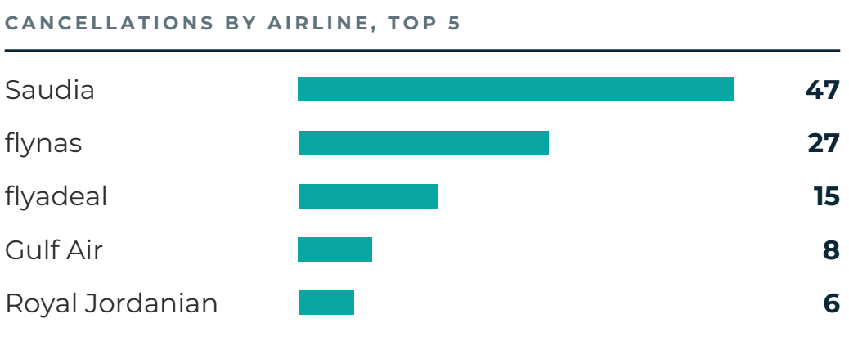
123	—	4:27 PM	0	5
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
51 departures + 72 arrivals, 21% of 589 scheduled.	None on the board.	SV918 from Liege, 97 min before 6:04 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:04 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 123 at 6:05 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

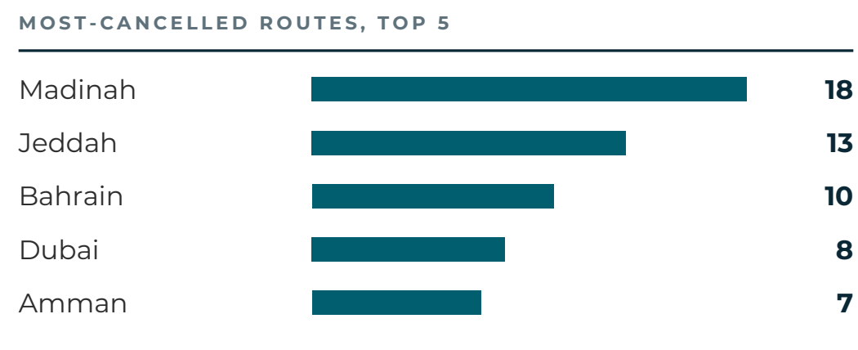
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	51	72	123	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	51 (18%)	72 (24%)	123	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	2 (1%)	2	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	4 (100%)	16 (89%)	20	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 215	1 of 200	1 of 415	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	5	5	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	26	36	62	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	202	179	381	FR24 stats panel

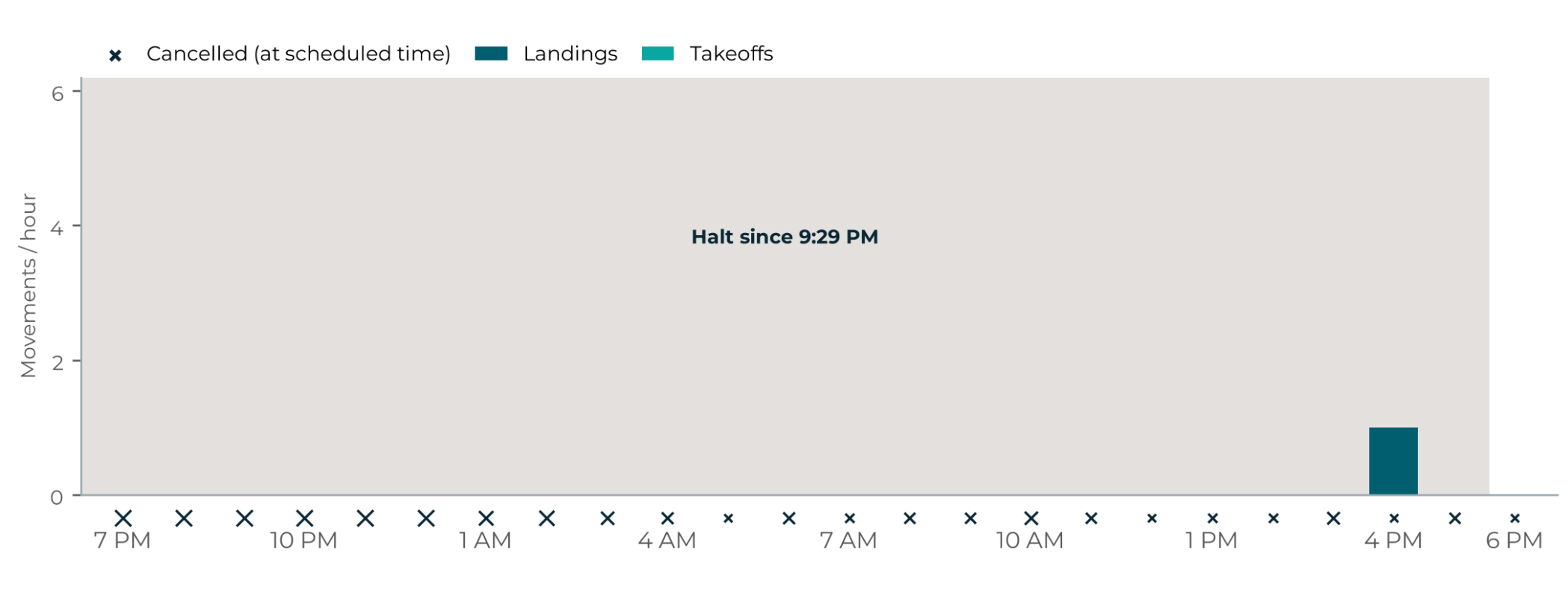
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



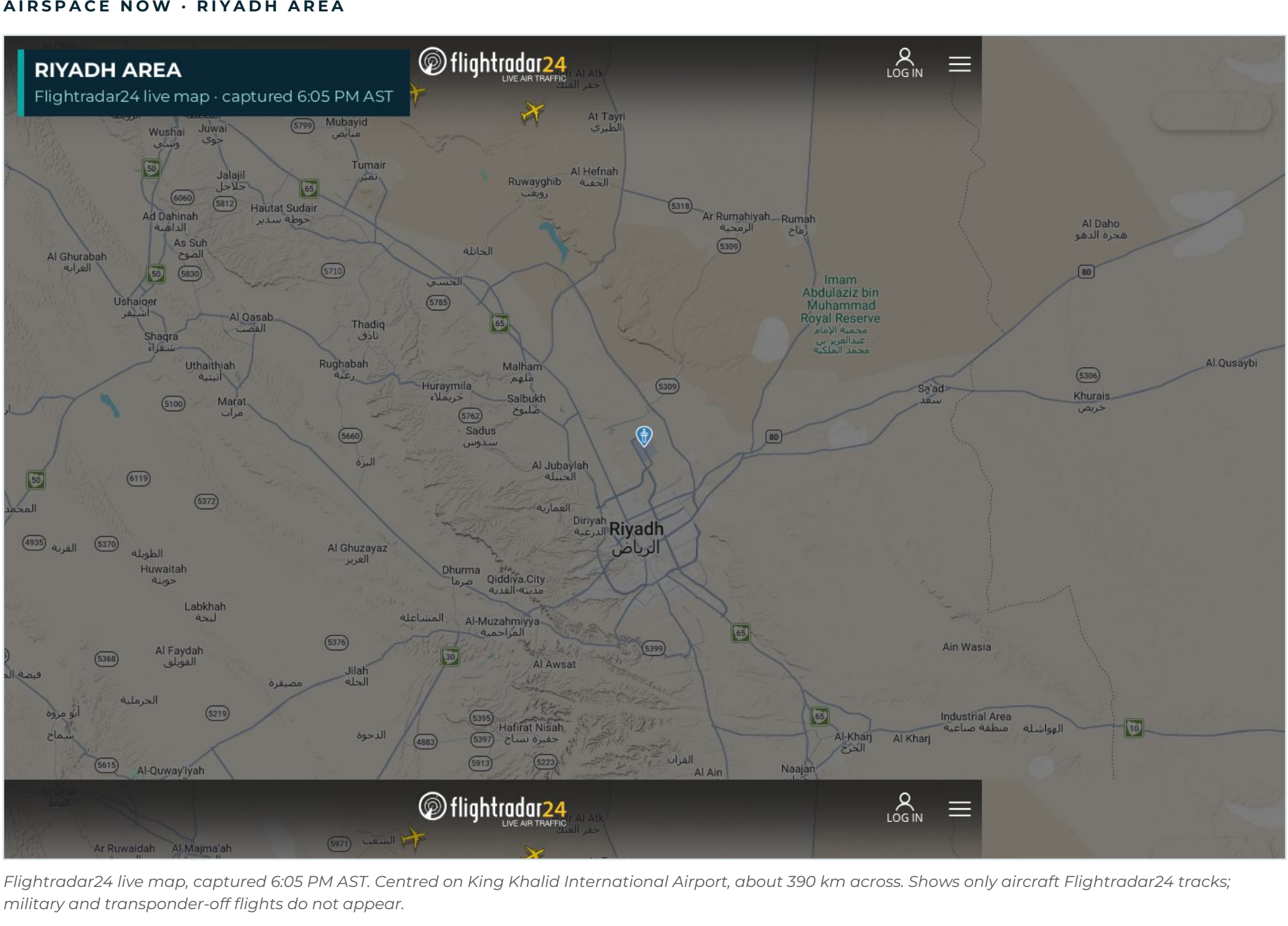
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 7:00 PM Sunday to 6:04 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's latest halt ran from 5:14 to 6:11 PM; traffic has kept moving since. Earlier Dammam halts in the window ran 9:42–11:11 PM, 12:17–1:05 AM, 1:15–2:04 AM, 2:49–4:29 AM, 8:17–9:18 AM and 10:49–11:35 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	11315 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:05 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

5

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 0 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

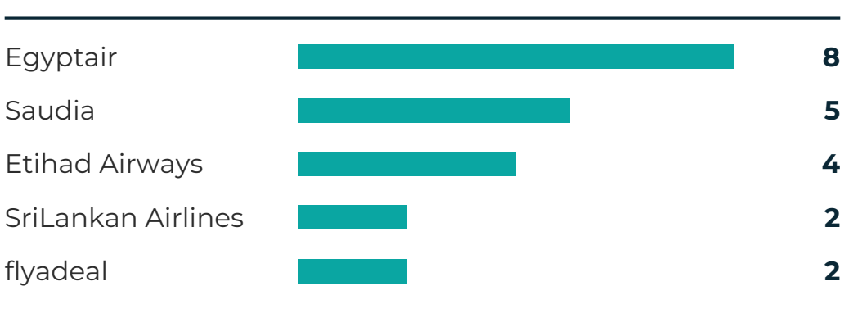
26	4:38 PM	5:59 PM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
10 departures + 16 arrivals, 13% of 203 scheduled.	F3467 to Madinah, 87 min before 6:04 PM.	XY812 from Dubai, 6 min before 6:04 PM.	2 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:04 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 26 at 6:05 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

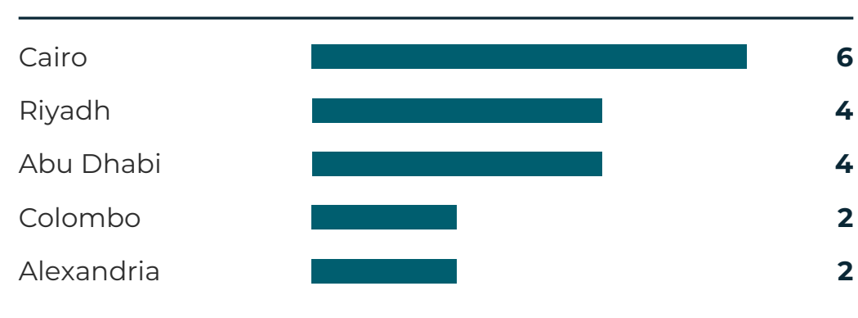
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	10	16	26	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	10 (10%)	16 (15%)	26	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	14 (14%)	5 (5%)	19	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	24 (63%)	32 (86%)	56	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	5 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	34 of 65	35 of 69	69 of 134	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	11	12	23	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	23	22	45	FR24 stats panel

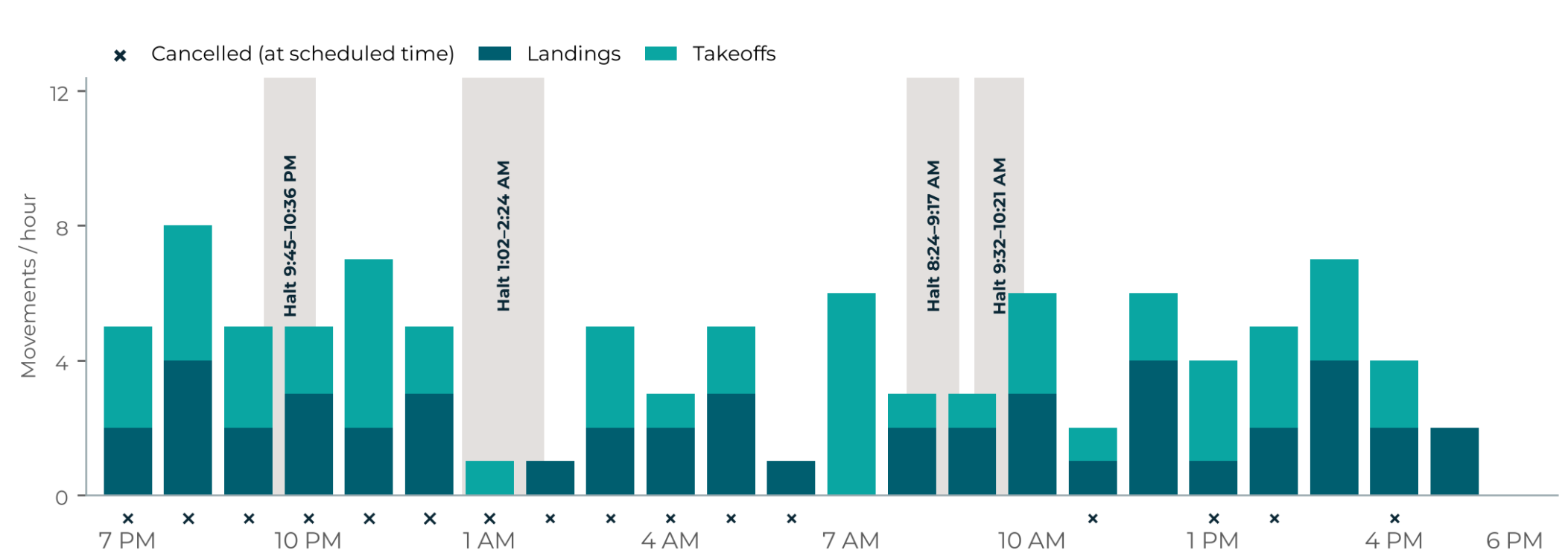
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (51) and landings (48) at DMM per hour from 7:00 PM Sunday to 6:04 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving: 3 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour; no halt since 12 PM (halts this morning 8:24 to 9:17 AM and 9:32 to 10:21 AM).

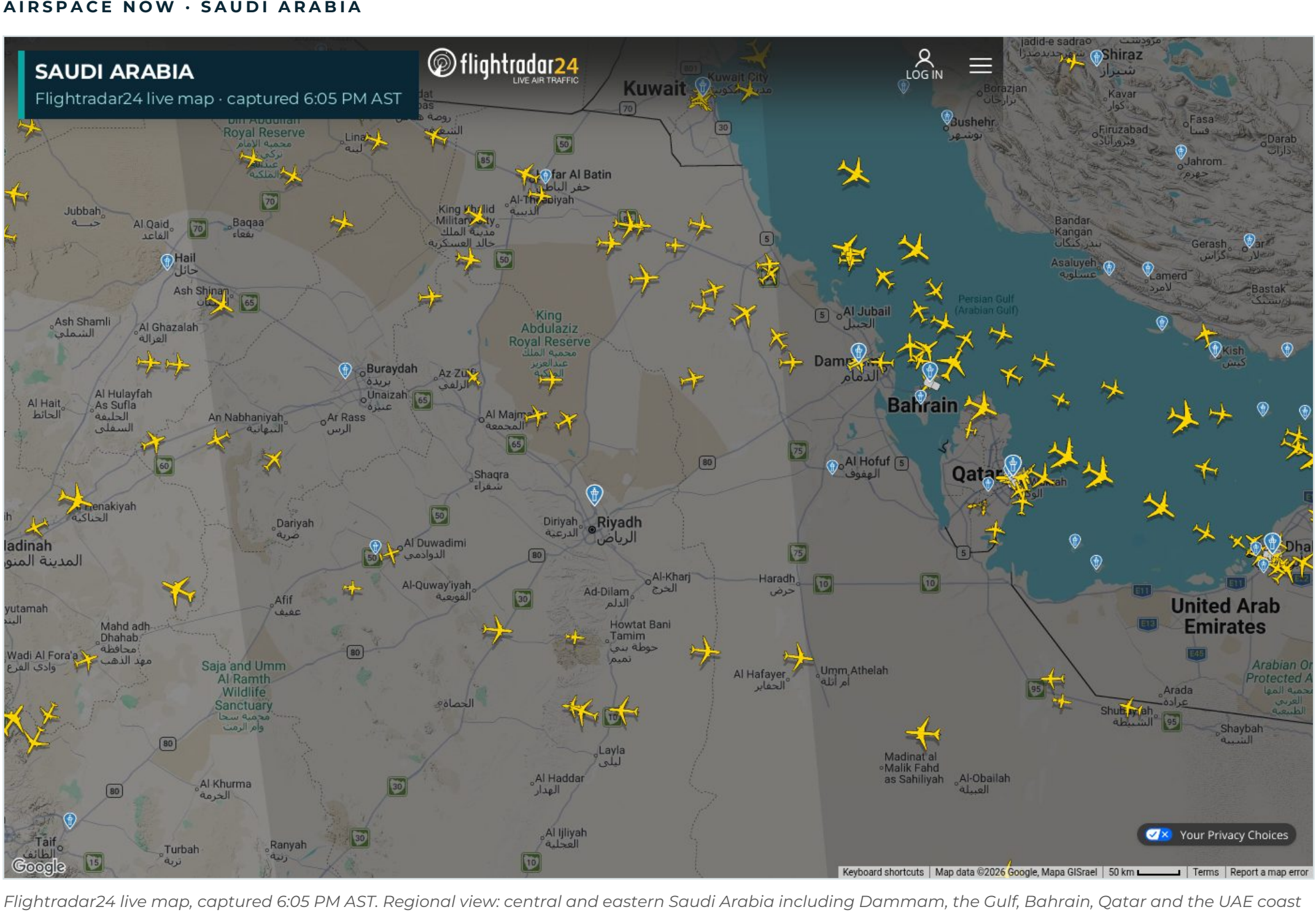
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 9:32–10:21 AM	49 min
Halt 8:24–9:17 AM	53 min
Halt 1:02–2:24 AM	81 min
Halt 9:45–10:36 PM	51 min
Halt 5:14–6:11 PM	57 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

CONFIRMED **SPA: Eastern Province Emir receives the CEO of Dammam Airports** (SPA (@SPAregions) · 1:40 PM · 1:40 PM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:05 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

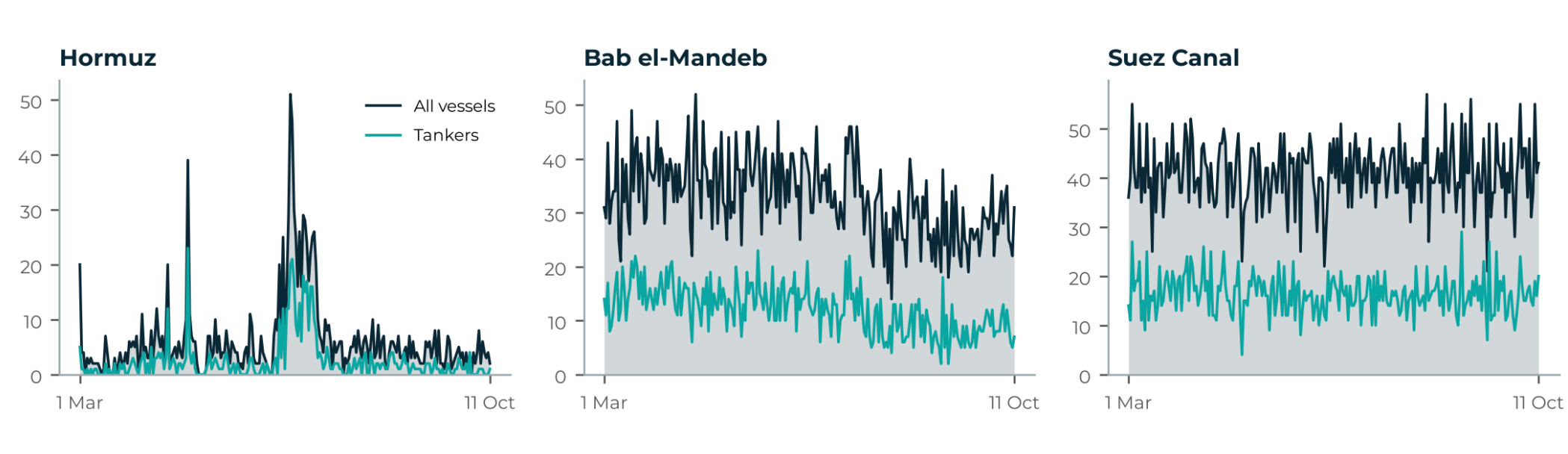
6

ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

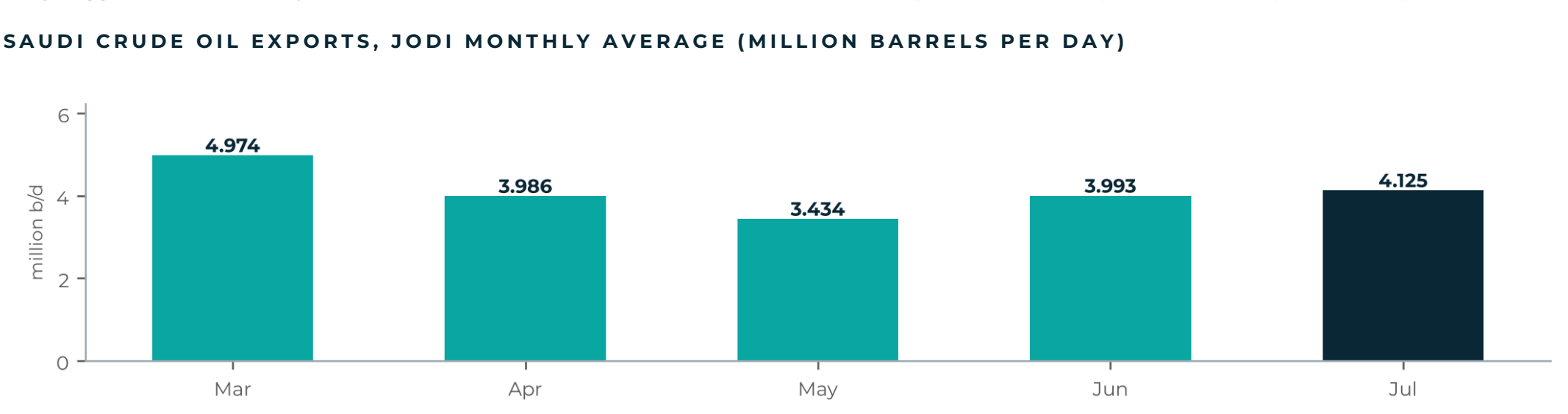
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 6:06 PM, Mon 19 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

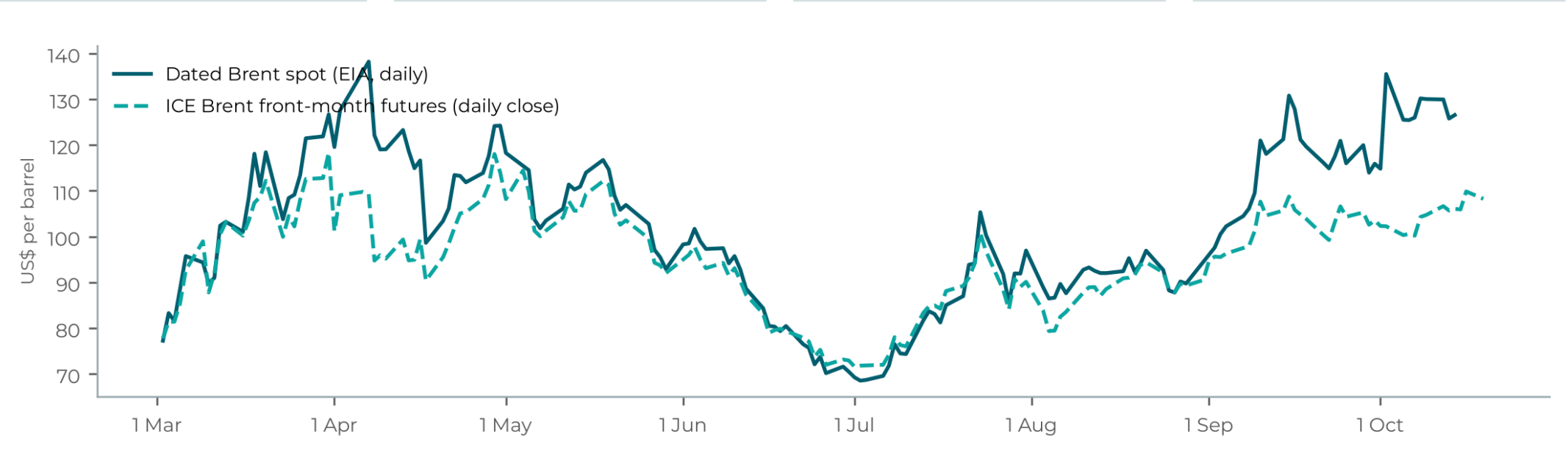


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$108.24	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 5:56 PM, Mon 19 Oct AST (-1.5% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

7

METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 6:04 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
6:04 PM, Mon 19 Oct	6:04 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	9:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 9:00 PM